

Quick quiz



Which feathers are used for flying?



Why do birds have large chest muscles?



Why do birds need light bones?

Bony support

The tips of the kingfisher's tiny wing bones are stuck together to make them stronger.

Folding wings

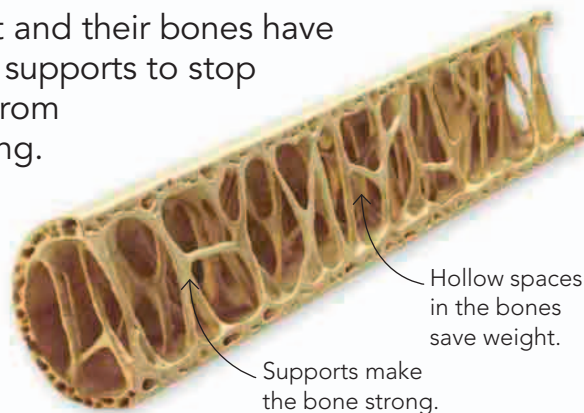
The kingfisher uses its wing muscles to fold its wings or to alter their shape. This helps the bird to change direction when it is flying.

Smooth shape

A top layer of small feathers gives the kingfisher its smooth shape.

Light bones

Flying uses a lot of energy but birds have light bodies to make flight easier. Their biggest bones are hollow to save weight and their bones have strong supports to stop them from breaking.



Tail feathers

The bird's tail feathers can spread out to help it slow down for landing.